



Small-Rink Defending

Angela Ruggiero - Lesson 5 companion - ~20 min on ice

Principle

- Less ice is a gift: fewer options for them, faster reads for you
- Stick on puck side always - your feet buy time, your stick buys angles

Drill 1 - Cross-ice 1v1 box - 10 min

- Half-width zone, nets on the dots - defender must steer, not chase
- Score only off the rush: teaches killing plays early
- Switch every 45 seconds; track steals vs beats out loud

Drill 2 - Wall pin timing - 6 min

- Puck dumped soft to the wall; defender arrives second on purpose
- Read hips, pin on the second touch, chin over the puck
- 6 reps each side

Write it down

- Count tonight: how many plays did you kill before the dot line?